

Name That Pope!

A pope will change their name to signify their new mission as head of the Church.



Jesus said to him in reply, "Blessed are you, Simon son of Jonah. For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my heavenly Father. And so I say to you, you are Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church."
- Matthew 16:16-18 NABRE



Number Challenge

Fill in the blank with the proper Roman numeral in place of the Arabic number next to the popes' names. Remember, if a smaller numeral is before a larger, you subtract from the larger numeral. If a smaller number is after a larger numeral, you add it.

I	1
V	5
X	10

St. Pope John Paul 2

II

Pope Leo 13

Blessed John 23

Blessed Pius 9

St. Gregory 7

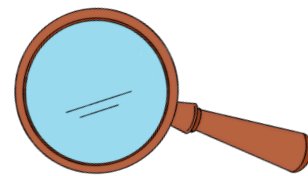
Pope Benedict 16



Did You Know?

Pope Francis is the first pope to take the name Francis. He chose the name after St. Francis of Assisi. He is the 265th successor of St. Peter.

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on what it is to be a leader on mission for God.

Important leaders are often remembered for the things they really cared about. If you were an important leader like a pope, a queen, or a principal, what would you want to be remembered for caring about?

All names have meaning. Do you know what your name means? If not, what's a word you think that describes how God made you? If you do know your name meaning, do you think it describes you well?

Response of Supplication

Use your reflections to guide a prayer for the pope.

Take a moment to pause and pray for our Holy Father, the Pope. He has a huge responsibility and needs our prayers. First thank God for him, then ask God to bless the Pope in a particular way.

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer with God.

Close your eyes and imagine you are walking with Jesus and His disciples through the beautiful path near the springs of Caesarea Philippi. It's a hot day, but the spray of the waterfall next to you is refreshing. The water crashing is loud, but you hear Jesus start to speak. He asks you all "Who do you say that I am?" How do you answer Him? Listen to your friend Simon as he says, "You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God." Jesus changes his name to Peter (which you know means "rock") and says, "Upon this rock, I will build my church." How does Peter react? How do the other disciples react? How do you react?



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